

estimation story.

Effects of information: The major paper is Bruner and Potter (1964). I thank Danny Kahneman for discussions and pointing out this paper to me. See also Montier (2007), Oskamp (1965), and Benartzi (2001). These biases become ambiguous information (Griffin and Tversky [1992]). For how they fail to disappear with expertise and training, see Kahneman and Tversky (1982) and Tversky and Kahneman (1982). See Kunda (1990) for how preference-consistent information is taken at face value, while preference-inconsistent information is processed critically.

Planning fallacy: Kahneman and Tversky (1979) and Buehler, Griffin, and Ross (2002). The planning fallacy shows a consistent bias in people's planning ability, even with matters of a repeatable nature—though it is more exaggerated with nonrepeatable events.

Wars: Trivers (2002).

Are there incentives to delay?: Flyvbjerg et al. (2002).

Oskamp: Oskamp (1965) and Montier (2007).

Task characteristics and effect on decision making: Shanteau (1992).

Epistēmē vs. Technē: This distinction harks back to Aristotle, but it recurs then dies? down—it most recently recurs in accounts such as tacit knowledge in “know how.” See Ryle (1949), Polanyi (1958/1974), and Mokyr (2002).

Catherine the Great: The number of lovers comes from Rounding (2006).

Life expectancy: www.annuityadvantage.com/lifeexpectancy.htm. For projects, I have used a probability of exceeding with a power-law exponent of 3/2: $f = Kx^{3/2}$. Thus the conditional expectation of x , knowing that x exceeds a

$$E[x|x>a] = \frac{\int_a^\infty x f(x) dx}{\int_a^\infty f(x) dx}.$$